

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

# cards-stack

Parallel items stacked vertically, full-width cards.

## Three forces are compressing the differentiation window.

### **Infrastructure has commoditized.**

The platform work that took us two years is now a managed service a competitor can switch on in an afternoon. The moat is no longer the stack.

### **Release cycles have collapsed.**

What used to ship annually now ships monthly. A visible advantage is matched before the next board meeting.

### **Switching costs are rising.**

Customers consolidate vendors and sign longer contracts. The window to win an account is shorter, and losing one lasts longer.

## Three patterns, each with its own pull.

### **Inventory.**

Equal-weight items the audience scans without ordering. The cards-grid family lives here — grid, stack, wide, side.

### **Comparison.**

Two or more items weighed against shared criteria. The verdict and compare families live here — they take sides.

### **Progression.**

Items that carry an explicit sequence. The list-steps and timeline families live here — order is load-bearing.

## Three reasons to keep cards-stack at three items.

1

### Cognitive load

Three is the threshold the audience can hold without effort. Past three, the slide demands working memory the room shouldn't have to spend.

2

### Vertical real estate

Each stacked card needs ~30% of the slide height to breathe. Four cards force you to shrink the cards until they stop reading as cards.

3

### Build path symmetry

cards-stack pairs with cards-grid (3-4 items) for at-a-glance comparison. One stack layout, not two, keeps the family's choices clean.

# Four workstreams, each with a current status pill.

## Signal intake

shipped

Connector v1 and multi-source dedupe are live across all three regions. Anomaly auto-routing lands next sprint.

## Scoring model

in review

The equal-weights baseline is calibrated; per-team weighting is in security review before the pilot opens.

## Retrospective loop

at risk

Outcome classification is still too coarse to score reliably. The owner is reworking the rubric this week.

## Rollout

not started

Gated on the scoring model clearing review, then sequenced for the following quarter.

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## When NOT to reach for cards-stack.

**Five or more items.** A fourth card fits with the `compact` modifier; past four the stack overflows. For five or more parallel items reach for cards-grid four, or split across slides.

**One-line cards.** If each card is a single short phrase, the stack reads as a padded list. Drop to `list` or `tldr` and reclaim the vertical space.

**Forced sequence.** Cards-stack is parallel content read in vertical order, not a numbered sequence. For explicit steps, use list-steps or list-criteria.

#### RELATED COMPONENTS

## See also.

- `cards-grid` — three or four parallel items in a scannable grid
- `compare-prose` — exactly two items, side by side
- `list-steps` — items carry an explicit, ordered sequence